# CHAPTER I

THE family of Dashwood had been long settled in Sussex. Their estate was large, and their residence was at Norland Park, in the centre of their property, where, for many generations, they had lived in so respectable a manner as to engage the general good opinion of their surrounding acquaintance. The late owner of this estate was a single man, who lived to a very advanced age, and who, for many years of his life, had a constant companion and housekeeper in his sister. But her death, which happened ten years before his own, produced a great alteration in his home; for to supply her loss he invited and received into his house the family of his nephew Mr. Henry Dashwood, the legal inheritor of the Norland estate, and the person to whom he intended to bequeath it. In the society of his nephew and niece, and their children, the old gentleman's days were comfortably spent. His attachment to them all increased. The constant attention of Mr. and Mrs. Henry Dashwood to his wishes, which proceeded not merely from interest, but from goodness of heart, gave him every degree of solid comfort which his age could receive; and the cheerfulness of the children added a relish to his existence.

By a former marriage, Mr. Henry Dashwood had one son: by his present lady three daughters. The son, a steady respectable young man, was amply provided for by the fortune of his mother, which had been large, and half of which devolved on him on his coming of age. By his own marriage, likewise, which happened soon afterwards, he added to his wealth. To him, therefore, the succession to the Norland estate was not so really important as to his sisters; for their fortune, independent of what might arise to them from their father's inheriting that property, could be but small. Their mother had nothing, and their father only seven thousand

"But then, while she was here in the house with us, I did not permit myself any liberties. And the worst of all is that she is already.... All this must needs happen just to spite me. Ar! ar! ar! But what, what is to be done?"

There was no answer except that common answer which life gives to all the most complicated and unsolvable questions, — this answer: You must live according to circumstances, in other words, forget yourself. But as you cannot forget yourself in sleep — at least till night, as you cannot return to that music which the water-bottle woman sang, therefore you must forget yourself in the dream of life!

"We shall see by and by," said Stepan Arkadyevitch to himself, and rising he put on his gray dressing-gown with blue silk lining, tied the tassels into a knot, and took a full breath into his ample lungs. Then with his usual firm step, his legs spread somewhat apart and easily bearing the solid weight of his body, he went over to the window, lifted the curtain, and loudly rang the bell. It was instantly answered by his old friend and valet Matve, who came in bringing his clothes, boots, and a telegram. Behind Matve came the barber with the shaving utensils.

"Are there any papers from the court-house?" asked Stepan Arkadyevitch, taking the telegram and taking his seat in front of the mirror.

.... "On the breakfast-table," replied Matve, looking inquiringly and with sympathy at his master, and after an instant's pause, added with a sly smile, "They have come from the boss of the livery-stable."

Stepan Arkadyevitch made no reply and only looked at Matve in the mirror. By the look which they interchanged it could be seen how they understood each other. The look of Stepan Arkadyevitch seemed to ask, "Why did you say that? Don't you know?"

Matve thrust his hands in his jacket pockets, kicked out his leg, and silently, good-naturedly, almost smiling, looked back to his master: —

"I ordered him to come on Sunday, and till then that

now stilled, now strident, cries and clangings, Anthony put his arm around the girl, drew her over to him and kissed her damp, childish mouth.

She was silent. She turned her face up to him, pale under the wisps and patches of light that trailed in like moonshine through a foliage. Her eyes were gleaming ripples in the white lake of her face; the shadows of her hair bordered the brow with a persuasive unintimate dusk. No love was there, surely; nor the imprint of any love. Her beauty was cool as this damp breeze, as the moist softness of her own lips.

"You're such a swan in this light," he whispered after a moment. There were silences as murmurous as sound. There were pauses that seemed about to shatter and were only to be snatched back to oblivion by the tightening of his arms about her and the sense that she was resting there as a caught, gossamer feather, drifted in out of the dark. Anthony laughed, noiselessly and exultantly, turning his face up and away from her, half in an overpowering rush of triumph, half lest her sight of him should spoil the splendid immobility of her expression. Such a kiss—it was a flower held against the face, never to be described, scarcely to be remembered; as though her beauty were giving off emanations of itself which settled transiently and already dissolving upon his heart.

. . . The buildings fell away in melted shadows; this was the Park now, and after a long while the great white ghost of the Metropolitan Museum moved majestically past, echoing sonorously to the rush of the cab.

"Why, Gloria! Why, Gloria!"

Her eyes appeared to regard him out of many thousand years: all emotion she might have felt, all words she might have uttered, would have seemed inadequate beside the adequacy of her silence, ineloquent against

Stuart differently. He says the two doctors argued over whether to save the baby or the mother, after the surgeon had already given instructions. He charged that so much precious time was wasted with such arguing, that, ultimately, they lost both the mother and the child. Stuart then goes to a lawyer, Mr. Murdoch, to see about charges of criminal neglect against those doctors. He tells Murdoch he got his information from an orderly—Harvey Pason.

## ON HER OWN

Heather is having a rough time in New York. She's being drawn into an affair she may not be able to get out of! Without enough money to pay the rent, Heather is relieved that her seemingly kindly landlady, Mrs. Hadeley, says she can forget about the rent until she gets herself established as a model! But little does Heather know that Mrs. Hadeley is in cahoots with Cal—the pornographic photographer *and who knows what else!*

On the eve of their wedding (Adam and Gina decided to get married right away without any fuss or complications), Gina tells Adam that since Judge Lowell is sick, she's going to go to Boston for a time to be with him. Adam is quite upset by the news. He feels Gina's trip to Boston is simply another excuse to avoid their getting married. Does she really want to get out of the wedding? Because the judge isn't seriously ill, Adam suggests that Gina not go to Boston right away, and instead get married as planned. But Gina is adamant. Adam then offers to go to Boston with her, stay as long as she likes, and *then* get married. Gina refuses! She says she wants to be alone! Adam hasn't said anything; but could Gina's hesitancy in marrying Adam be due to her uncertain feelings where Gary is concerned?

A hurt, angry and bewildered Adam goes to Mark. He says he doesn't know where he stands with Gina, and he certainly doesn't like Gary's affect on Gina! Adam says he turned down an offer a couple of weeks ago to open up a new obstetrics unit at one of the finest hospitals in Colombia, South American because they were getting married—but he has now changed his mind and *will* accept the project and see if he can persuade Gina to go with him (it would keep them out of the country for a few weeks). Adam admits it's a test of her love for him; but he's got to know where he stands, and he feels that if they don't marry now, they never will. Unhappily for Adam, Gina makes a very definite choice. She insists on leaving for Boston . . .

Monica is quite taken with Alan, who will be setting up the new cardiac wing at General Hosptial—and Alan is uncomfortably aware of her feelings! When she even goes so far as to intimate to him that she certainly wouldn't mind spending her evenings working with him, he tells her she won't have to worry about working evenings, as his fiancée keeps him very busy nights! A bemused Alan later confides to Mark that he's not really engaged; but he often finds it necessary to invent a fiancée to ward off the unwanted attentions of amorous females!

# Barefoot Boy with Cheek?

(*Continued from page 45*)

The words reach Tony but fail to register, because in his imagination he is once again the hero about to do battle with the forces of evil.

Though the young boy has grown into a man now, he still lives partly in his imagination. As a youngster in Boston, from a better than ordinary social and economic background, Tony Perkins fashioned for himself a romantic world to liven an otherwise well-regulated existence. As a film star he is still playing the same game.

Because he is really what he seems to be—a nice enough, ordinary young fellow—and because he feels that as an actor he should be more colorful, Tony has been working overtime at it.

Sometimes his attempts at achieving color border on the ridiculous. During the filming of "Friendly Persuasion" he used to eat regularly at Googie's, a small coffee shop next door to Schwab's in Hollywood. He told new acquaintances there that he worked in an airplane factory. "I thought they'd like me better if they didn't think I was another actor in competition with them," he says by way of explanation.

More likely, Tony hoped that when they did learn he was starring in a big film, they would be amazed at his modesty. He was also hoping that the discovery of who he really was would have some dramatic impact.

Tony was playing a game much as Jimmy Dean did the day he drove up to the "Giant" location in Marfa, Texas. Finding a new gateman on the job, Dean tried to get in without announcing himself as a star of the film. In blue jeans and leather jacket, with his old junk car, Jimmy hardly looked like an actor, and he knew it.

But he wanted to test the policeman to see if the man knew who he was; just as Tony was probably testing the new acquaintances to see if they had heard of him.

Much of Tony's eccentric behavior is likened to Jimmy's and is equally studied. For example, Tony is reported to have walked out of his apartment many times barefoot, supposedly having forgotten to put on his shoes.

Unquestionably, it must take a certain amount of cheek to carry off this kind of activity. In Tony's case, however, much of the odd behavior is reported rather than seen. And the reporter is invariably Tony, who tells interviewers how he walked out of the house barefoot.

To a large extent these stories have been successful, but a few have backfired. For example, in a recent *Life* magazine story, much was made of the fact that Tony hitchhiked daily to Paramount Studios from his apartment, and that he cooked his meals on a hot plate in his room. As a matter of fact, he may have hitchhiked to Paramount once for the record, but it's certain that he didn't do it as a daily habit. As for cooking in his room, the management at Tony's apartment was miffed at the story because cooking in nonhousekeeping rooms is frowned upon. When they were told that it was all for publicity, no serious damage was sustained.

Some of the stories have the ring of familiarity. Tony once said he would "rather be called a 'young' anything than 'another young' anything." Marlon Brando said it earlier, and the late Humphrey Bogart said it before Marlon.

Sometimes it's not that Tony tells deliberate untruths about himself, but that he allows you to assume things. He cleverly throws out the bait, lets the listener nibble, and then plays out the line. Here's a for-instance: During a recent interview Tony said something about going on his bike to a party. The interviewer knew that Tony had a date, so he asked if she was on the bike, too. Tony's answer was merely a smile. The reporter assumed that the girl went on the bike—which she didn't—but the story spread.

To an interviewer Tony has a chameleon-like quality, changing protective coloration to accommodate the questions. He can shift easily from shy ingenuousness to long thoughtful silences broken by terse phrases or half sentences. With his head lowered he will look up at you, a perplexing, reflective look on his face. You want to know everything about him; you sense the shifting emotions, the racing and twisting thoughts. Although you often suspect that he is telling a half-truth or acting boastfully modest, you go along with him because, in a word, Tony has charm.

Everyone who comes in contact with Tony is aware of this charm, including the housekeeper at the Chateau Marmont where he now lives. Norma Moore, one of Tony's Hollywood dates, considers him one of the most charming men she has ever met—and one of the most unpredictable. The charm which he turns on and off at will enables him to keep his head above the flood of stories which he has caused to circulate about himself.

One day while I was talking with Tony at Paramount, Autumn Russell, a very pretty contract player, joined us. The change in Tony was remarkable. It was almost as though someone had told him that the cameras were grinding, and he suddenly flashed charm from every pore. His stories became more elaborate. His own importance in them increased. He was doing as any man would—trying to impress a pretty girl.

But, more important, Tony knew Autumn was married, so he had no intention of asking her for a date. Yet she represented an interested audience. Like many young actors, Tony only needs one other person and he's on-stage. If the other person happens to be a pretty female, so much the better.

With all this, Tony can be far more businesslike in an interview than stars many years his senior. During a talk with me for this story, he asked if I had brought a tape recorder along. When I said no, he seemed disappointed. I asked why.

"With a tape recorder there would be no chance of being misquoted," he said.

I explained that I was going to take comprehensive notes. He seemed pleased. "I get nervous when people don't take notes," he said.

The interview was conducted at Lucey's restaurant across the street from Paramount. Tony, who doesn't drink or smoke, ordered a light supper and told me how he came to be an actor.

He was born twenty-four years ago on Twenty-Third Street in New York. His father was Osgood Perkins, a matinee idol of the Twenties; his mother was a Wellesley College graduate and a socialite. The Perkins had been married ten years before Tony was born. He was their only child.

Osgood Perkins died when Tony was five, and Tony says he has no memories of him. Following her husband's death Tony's mother moved with him to Brookline, Massachusetts.

Until this time, Tony spoke mostly French as he had been raised by a French governess.

As a child Tony was considered something of a hell-raiser. He fought a lot with other children. His favorite game was to stuff an old suit of clothes with rags and blankets and throw it in front of passing cars. "I was threatened with reform school many times as a kid," Tony recalls with satisfaction. "I guess it's a miracle I never got in real trouble."

Tony's first ambition was to be a lifeguard, followed by an overwhelming wish to be an actor. Perhaps hours spent probing over his father's old scrapbooks had something to do with that. In high school Tony appeared in all of the school plays.

Since Osgood Perkins had gone to Harvard, Tony was enrolled at Browne and Nichols, a preparatory school for Harvard. He did not cause much of a flurry in academic circles. In fact, the only high school subject in which Tony excelled was French, which he spoke fluently, thanks to his childhood training. But he kept his knowledge of the language a secret and progressed normally with his class "That way I was sure of good grades in at least one subject," he recalled.

"Schoolteachers," he added with a grin, "like to think I'm a boy who needs mothering. That's how I got through high school, and I guess that's my appeal now to moviegoers."

His appeal to moviegoers is certainly a strong one, maternal or otherwise. But if playing the little boy was enough to get Tony through school, it was not enough, apparently, to get him into college. He was the first student in the history of Browne and Nichols who was not allowed to take the Harvard entrance examinations because his marks were so low.

After leaving prep school he took odd courses, did summer stock (including "Years Ago," a Ruth Gordon play) and passed some time at Rollins College in Florida. Eventually he wound up in New York's Columbia University taking extension courses.

It was during his stay at Columbia that Tony heard M-G-M had bought "Years Ago" and planned to film it under the title, "The Actress." On a hunch he hitchhiked to the coast and said he'd like to test for the part.

He was signed. After five weeks "The Actress" was finished and Tony went back to New York. He made sure he was in New York when the picture was released. But no one seemed impressed with it.

Then Tony went for an interview with Otto Preminger for the part of Joseph, opposite Rita Hayworth, in Columbia's "Joseph and His Brethren." He didn't make it. Mr. Preminger took one look at him and said, "I'm sorry, Mr. Perkins, you won't do. We're looking for Old Testament faces. You have a New Testament face."

With his New Testament face Tony went to see Elia Kazan for the lead in "East of Eden." He ended up with a Broadway role in "Tea and Sympathy."

"I almost didn't take the 'Tea' part because I didn't think I was good enough to do it," Tony recalled. "But then I figured that if Kazan thought I was good enough, I must be."

Later in the interview, Tony told me that he had expected to get the "Tea" role because he was "equipped to play it."

"My success has been a sort of chain reaction," he said. "It started with summer stock, then 'Years Ago,' the film and some good TV parts. Then came 'Friendly Persuasion.' I haven't been out of work for more than a week in years. I guess